



Colours in Black

The Science of Chromatography



What Colour Is This?

Look at this black sketch pen. It looks like just one colour, right? But wait until you see what happens next!

Let's solve this mystery together!

Black hides a rainbow inside!



Black Is a Mixture

Black ink looks like one colour but is many mixed together!

Like chaat masala – it looks brown but is really cumin, dry mango, black salt, and pepper all mixed up!



Water as a Separator

Water can carry different colours at different speeds! Think of haldi (turmeric) in water – the yellow colour spreads out slowly and beautifully.



Paper as a Racetrack

Paper soaks water and gives colours a racetrack to run!



Let's Get Ready!

Black Sketch
Pen

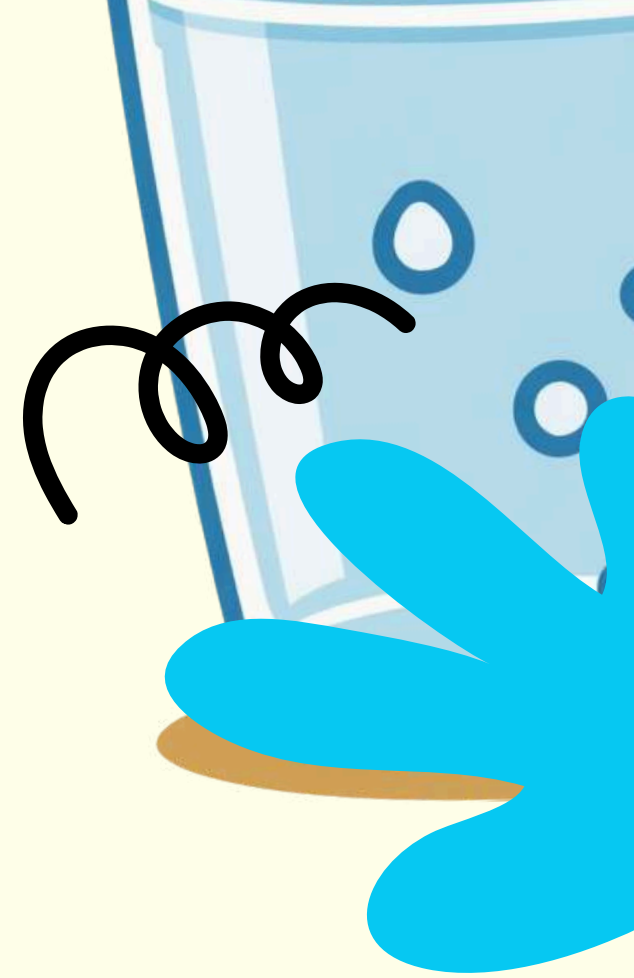
Filter Paper

Water

Pencil

Small Katori

Scissors



Step 1: Cut the Paper Strip

Cut a paper strip that is 2 cm wide and 10-12 cm long. Ask an adult to help you with the scissors!



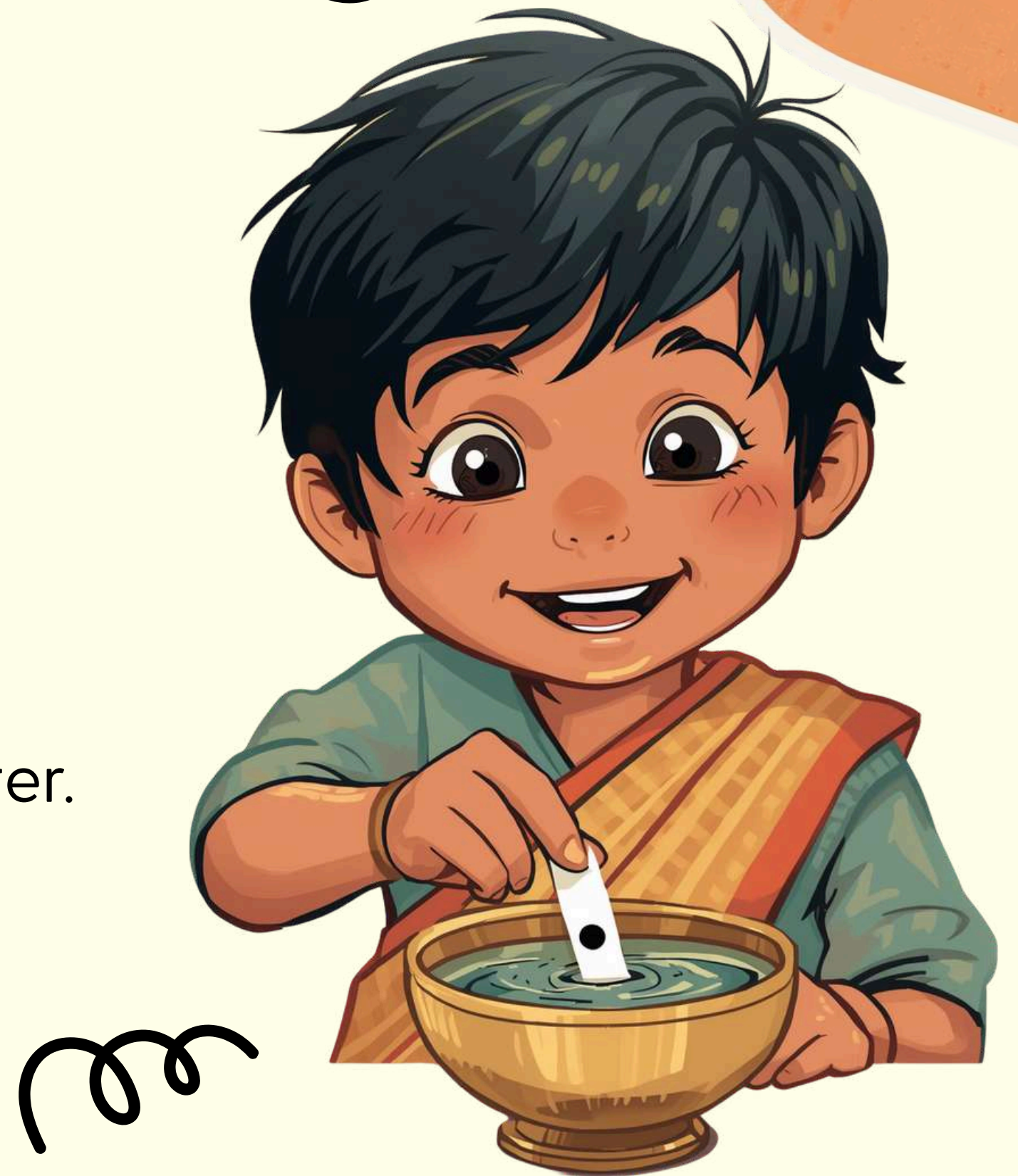
Step 2: Draw a Black Dot

Draw a thick black dot about 2 cm from the bottom of your paper strip. Use your ruler to measure! Now wait 30 seconds for the ink to dry completely.



Step 3: Dip in Water

Dip the tip of your paper strip (below the dot) into the water in your katori. Important: The black dot must NOT touch the water! Only the very bottom of the paper should be in the water.



Step 4: Watch the Magic!

Hold the strip for 5-8 minutes. Watch carefully as water climbs up slowly and the colours start to separate like magic!



Step 5: Look at the Colours!

Remove your strip from the water and let it dry.
Now look closely at all the beautiful colours!
Draw or describe what you see on your strip.



Why Did That Happen?

Paper is the racetrack for colours

Water climbs up and carries
colours

Some colours run faster

Some colours run slower



The Big Word: **CHROMATOGRAPHY**

CHRO-MA-TO-GRAPHY

Clap it out! 🖐️🖐️🖐️🖐️

Chroma = Colour

Graphy = Drawing or Writing

It means "Colour Writing!" ✨

Who uses Chromatography?



Reserve Bank of India (RBI)

Food scientists

Police labs

Chromatography helps very
important people everyday!

Quiz Question 1

Black ink is made of _____

Let's test what you learned about the colours
hiding inside black ink!

A) Only one colour

B) Many colours mixed together

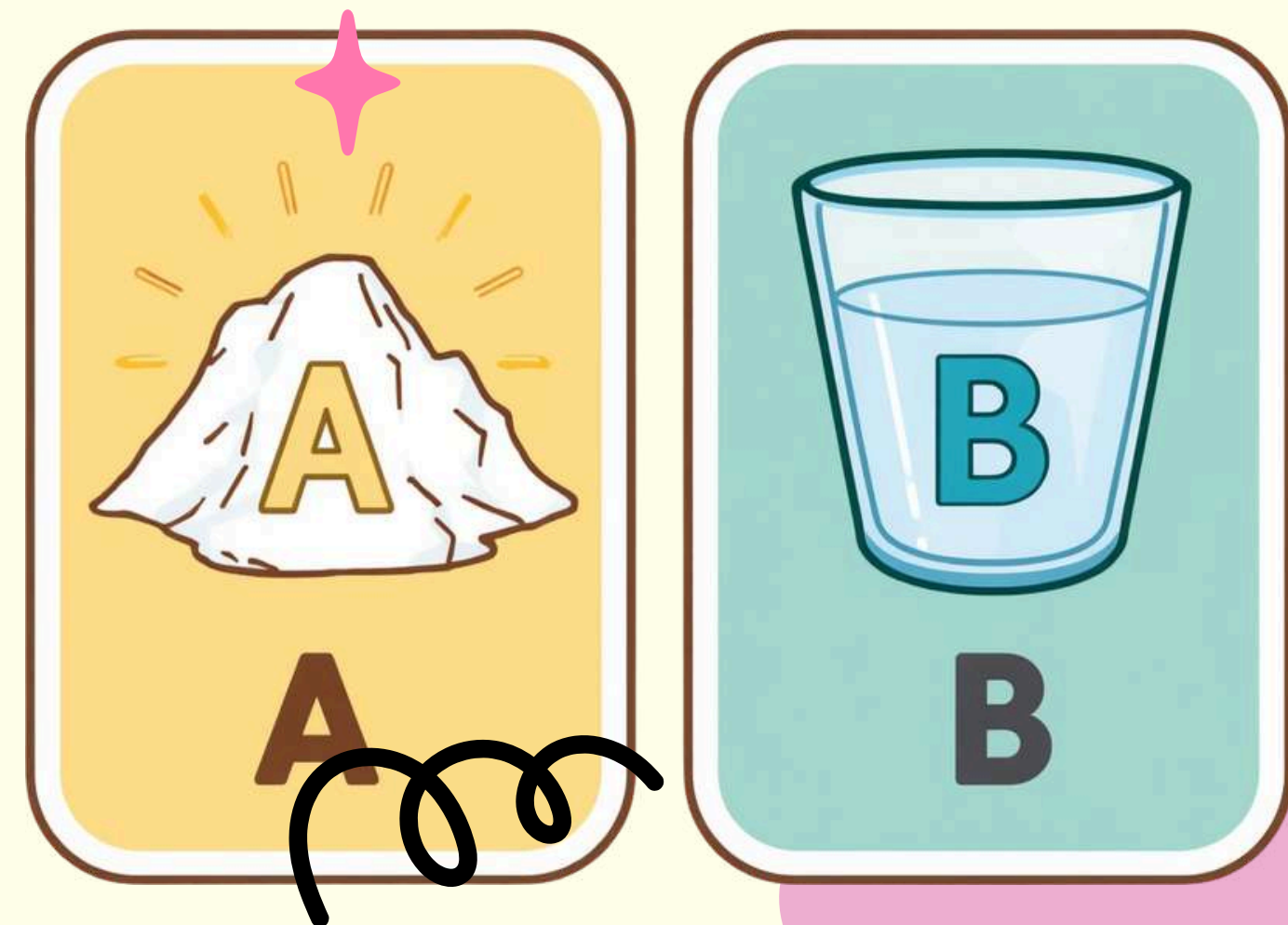


Quiz Question 2

In our experiment, what helped separate the colours?

A) Salt

B) Water



Quiz Question 3

The name of separating colours using paper and water is called _____

A) Photography

B) Chromatography



Planrs Academy

**Thank you junior
chromatographer!**

